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# Week 4 Preview

1 message

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SUMER SPORTS




## Week 4 Preview

## A Quick Note.

- The data you see below comes from SumerSports' SumerPass. We recommend you check it out if you want to dive deeper into the data, build your own stats, or get live charting on game days.
- Today's newsletter has some thoughts on rushing efficiency, our film favorites, and our three biggest questions of the week along with their respective preview boxes. For the rest of the game preview boxes, head over to Tej's page where they will all be posted Thursday.

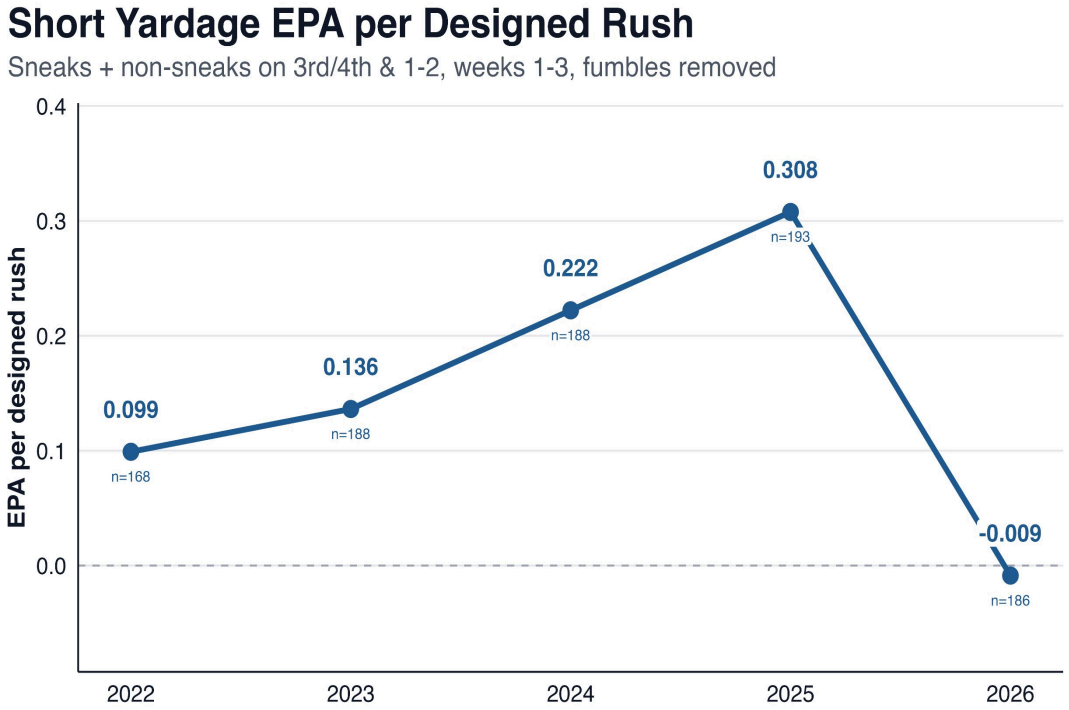
## Running the Ball in 2026

**Through three weeks, leaguewide rushing EPA is down.**

- Here are EPA/designed rush and designed rush success rate through three weeks for each of the last four seasons. Fumbles are removed here, though the trend line is consistent if we were to include them.
    - **2026: -0.10, 41.5%**
    - 2025: -0.06, 40.4%
    - 2024: -0.07, 41.6%
    - 2023: -0.10, 40.4%

**Success rate is in a good spot, so what gives?**

- One big area where the EPA/designed rush numbers have dipped is in short yardage situations. On 3rd and 4th downs with 1 or 2 yards to go, we have the following EPA/designed rush and conversion rates over the last four seasons:
    - **2026: -0.01, 67.7%**
    - 2025: 0.31, 71.5%
    - 2024: 0.22, 71.8%
    - 2023: 0.14, 71.8%



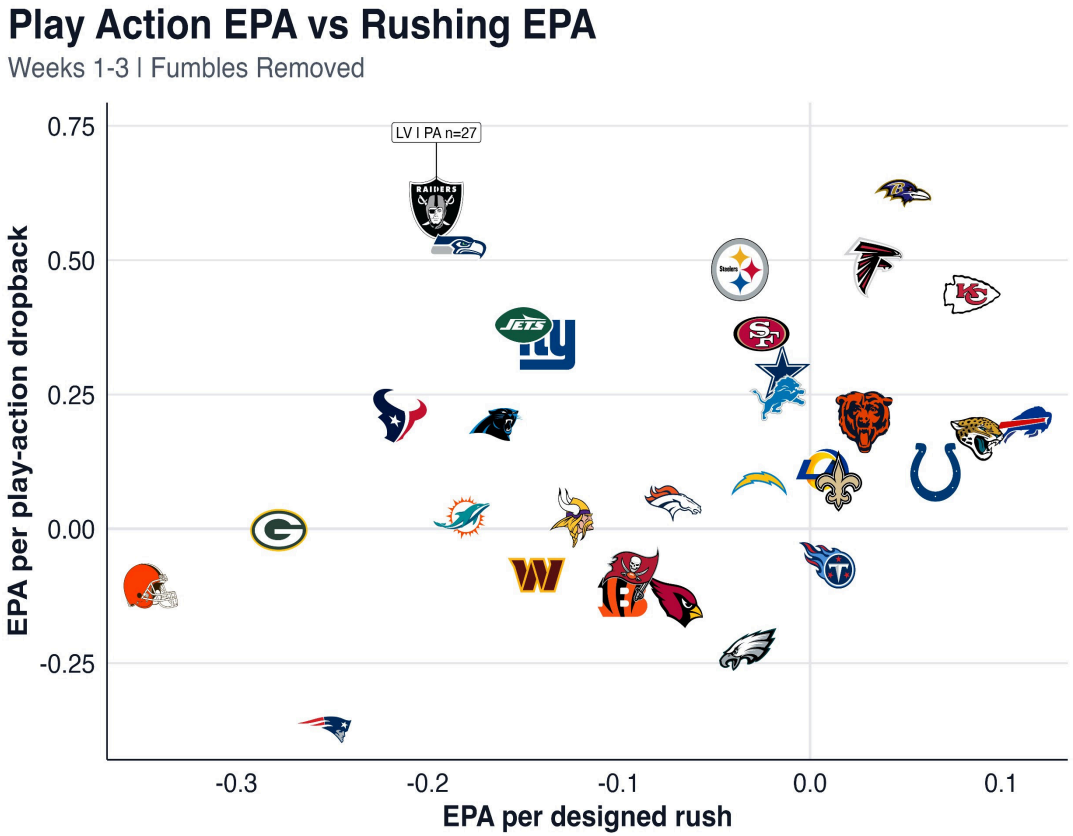

- Non-QB sneak runs in those short yardage situations have dropped from a 66.9% conversion rate in 2025 down to 61.5% in 2026. Sneaks have also dipped a bit from an 86.7% conversion rate in 2025 to 84.3% in 2026.
- Short yardage runs have also seen a higher rate of plays with at least one negatively graded blocker this year. The conversion rate on 3rd and 4th down with 1 or 2 yards to the line to gain is 70% with no negatively graded offensive lineman, but 41% when there is at least one negatively graded offensive lineman.

**Here are some team performances in short yardage with sneaks removed.**

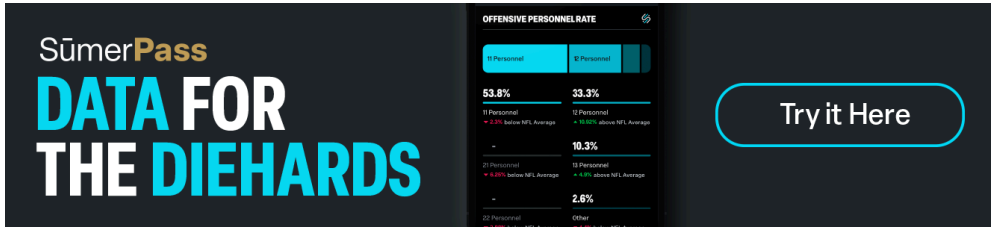
- Three teams that have succeeded in short yardage situations with sneaks removed: Rams (5/5), Commanders (4/4), Bears (5/6), and Saints (6/7).
- Three teams that have struggled in short yardage situations with sneaks removed: Browns (0/5), Seahawks (0/5), Ravens (1/4), and Texans (1/4).

**Let's talk about the Raiders run game.**

- The Las Vegas Raiders are off to a 3-0 start with a well-designed offense from Klint Kubiak. While Kubiak found ways to isolate Brock Bowers in Week 3 and dug into his shot play bag in Week 2, the run game is struggling. The Raiders offense ranks 24th in EPA/rush and 10th in EPA/dropback. Kubiak's Seahawks ranked 22nd in EPA/rush and 9th in EPA/dropback last season.
- Even with that, the Raiders are still productive off play action, as were the 2025 Seattle Seahawks. The Raiders rank 1st in play action while maintaining a below average EPA/rush.
- This is just one example that suggests a highly statistically efficient running game is not a prerequisite for an effective play action attack. We generally think that if an offense can present enough of a threat of a run through personnel, concepts, pulling linemen, and the use of under center fakes tied to their play action, then there can be yards to be had off play action regardless of the run game's success.









## Film Favorites

**Here are some interesting things from the all-22 this week with clips hyperlinked:**

- The Chiefs under center game is getting dangerous.
- The Raiders created space for Brock Bowers to be a true #1 threat.
- Kaden Elliss is one of our favorite gap plugging linebackers that is changing pictures in the run game.
- Parker Wasington joined the list of wide receivers to line up at fullback.
- Shane Steichen had a nifty red zone design.
- The 49ers created a massive opening off play action.
- Teams continue to build off the slice concept.
- Be careful throwing that in breaker against cover 4.
- Bijan Robinson and outside zone are a perfect pairing.
- The Eagles do have routes going over the middle of the field, but they are often later in the progression.

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## Week 3 Questions We Want Answered

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**Jacksonville Jaguars @ Cincinnati Bengals: Will the Bengals offensive line shut down the Jaguars pass rush?**

- Bengals right tackle Amarius Mims is off to a great start to the season. He has not let up a pressure and had strong battles with TJ Watt last week. Ted Karras ranks 11th/32 in pressure rate allowed at center and Dalton Risner is 24th/62 at guard. The left side of the line ranks close to the bottom of the league in pressure rate allowed.
- The Bengals have had five charted pass blocker on 75.2% of their dropbacks. Jacksonville has shown they can pressure with four, but the Bengals have the 6th best pressure rate allowed against four-man rushes.

- The Jaguars pass rush is 2nd in pressure rate and 2nd in quick pressure rate this season. Their opponents this year have struggled in the pressure department this year, but the Jacksonville edge rotation is still deep.

- If Burrow is protected, we will want to see how he attacks the middle of the field. The Bengals are 5th in middle of the field throw rate and the Jaguars are 32nd in middle of the field EPA allowed, but on a very small sample.

# CIN Offense vs. JAX Defense

Week 4 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-3 data · raw EPA • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

## Overall

| UNIT | EPA/PLAY | EPA/DB | EPA/RUSH | SUCCESS RATE | PASS OE | EXPLOSIVE % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CIN Offense | 0.04 (#9) | 0.12 (#12) | -0.10 (#19) | 43.4% (#15) | 6.8% (#3) | 10.3% (#9) |
| JAX Defense | -0.16 (#5) | -0.14 (#6) | -0.18 (#9) | 41.7% (#8) | -2.9% (#8) | 11.0% (#27) |

## Personnel Usage

| UNIT | 11P % | 11P EPA | 12P % | 12P EPA | 21P % | 21P EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CIN Offense | 53.1% (#23) | -0.09 (#19) | 40.0% (#1) | 0.33 (#2) | 4.0% (#13) | -0.45 (#19) |
| JAX Defense | 68.7% (#4) | -0.04 (#15) | 17.8% (#24) | -0.47 (#1) | 6.7% (#14) | -0.28 (#8) |

## Run & Play Action Identity

| UNIT | ZONE % | ZONE EPA | PA % | PA EPA | UC % | UC EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CIN Offense | 69.5% (#6) | -0.07 (#10) | 20.4% (#28) | -0.29 (#31) | 31.4% (#28) | -0.10 (#26) |
| JAX Defense | 46.7% (#29) | -0.23 (#10) | 29.2% (#11) | -0.51 (#1) | 42.3% (#13) | -0.44 (#1) |

## Safety Shell & Middle of Field

| UNIT | 1-HIGH % | 1-HIGH EPA | 2-HIGH % | 2-HIGH EPA | MOF % | MOF EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CIN Offense | 46.9% (#4) | -0.08 (#19) | 53.1% (#29) | 0.30 (#6) | 26.2% (#5) | 0.46 (#8) |
| JAX Defense | 39.2% (#12) | -0.05 (#16) | 60.8% (#21) | -0.20 (#2) | 13.3% (#5) | 1.03 (#32) |

## Blitz & Pressure

| UNIT | BLITZ % | BLITZ EPA | NON-BLITZ EPA | PRESSURE % | PRESSURE EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CIN Offense | 32.7% (#7) | -0.35 (#25) | 0.35 (#4) | 34.5% (#7) | -0.18 (#8) |
| JAX Defense | 24.7% (#23) | 0.07 (#18) | -0.21 (#3) | 46.4% (#2) | -0.63 (#7) |

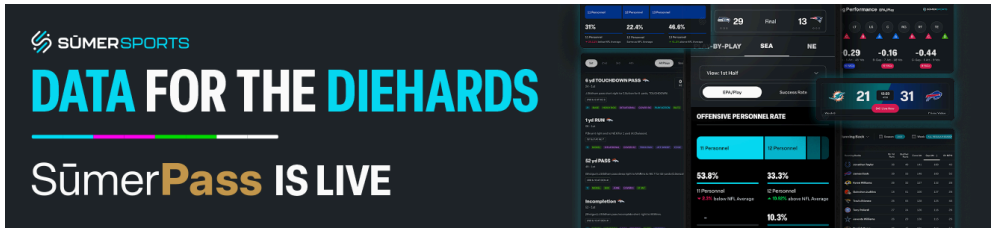
## Pass Depth

| UNIT | SHORT % | SHORT EPA | INTER. % | INTER. EPA | DEEP % | DEEP EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CIN Offense | 71.8% (#7) | -0.25 (#31) | 21.4% (#19) | 1.17 (#2) | 6.8% (#27) | 2.59 (#1) |
| JAX Defense | 57.8% (#28) | -0.44 (#1) | 25.3% (#9) | 0.53 (#17) | 16.9% (#3) | 0.85 (#26) |

## Defensive Personnel & Box Count

| UNIT | BASE % | BASE EPA | NICKEL % | NICKEL EPA | LIGHT BOX % | LIGHT BOX EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CIN Offense | 14.3% (#31) | 0.17 (#5) | 76.0% (#4) | -0.08 (#22) | 44.6% (#14) | 0.41 (#4) |
| JAX Defense | 28.2% (#21) | -0.47 (#1) | 57.1% (#18) | 0.03 (#22) | 49.1% (#8) | 0.05 (#19) |

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**Denver Broncos @ San Francisco 49ers: Can the Broncos slow down Brock Purdy's incredible start?**

- Brock Purdy has gotten off to an insane start to the season. He is 1st in EPA/dropback, has not taken a sack this year, and Kyle Shanahan has dialed up a 5.7% pass rate over expected for him. He is also 2nd in catchable throw rate and can extend plays to create something out of nothing.
- The 49ers offensive line also deserves credit this season. They have the 2nd lowest pressure allowed rate overall and all 5 blockers up front rank well at their position.
- The Broncos are 21st in pressure rate but 5th in EPA/play allowed when getting a pressure. Zach Allen and Nik Bonitto have anchored the pass rush so far this season and still have the ability to ruin a game.
- We want to see how the 49ers respond when the Broncos blitz. Purdy has shredded the blitz so far this year, and Denver has the 6th highest blitz rate in the league.

# SF Offense vs. DEN Defense

Week 4 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-3 data · raw EPA • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

## Overall

| UNIT | EPA/PLAY | EPA/DB | EPA/RUSH | SUCCESS RATE | PASS OE | EXPLOSIVE % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SF Offense | 0.35 (#1) | 0.66 (#1) | -0.03 (#10) | 55.4% (#2) | 5.7% (#4) | 13.4% (#3) |
| DEN Defense | -0.02 (#20) | -0.12 (#8) | 0.14 (#32) | 43.4% (#14) | 2.1% (#24) | 9.7% (#18) |

## Personnel Usage

| UNIT | 11P % | 11P EPA | 12P % | 12P EPA | 21P % | 21P EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SF Offense | 31.8% (#31) | 0.51 (#1) | 15.3% (#28) | 0.52 (#1) | 44.6% (#1) | 0.11 (#7) |
| DEN Defense | 60.2% (#12) | -0.02 (#17) | 17.9% (#23) | -0.36 (#3) | 0.0% (#29) | NA |

## Run & Play Action Identity

| UNIT | ZONE % | ZONE EPA | PA % | PA EPA | UC % | UC EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SF Offense | 77.6% (#1) | -0.09 (#12) | 27.9% (#14) | 0.36 (#5) | 58.6% (#1) | 0.17 (#2) |
| DEN Defense | 52.0% (#23) | -0.01 (#26) | 22.7% (#28) | -0.20 (#5) | 37.2% (#24) | 0.03 (#20) |

## Safety Shell & Middle of Field

| UNIT | 1-HIGH % | 1-HIGH EPA | 2-HIGH % | 2-HIGH EPA | MOF % | MOF EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SF Offense | 22.1% (#30) | 0.96 (#1) | 77.9% (#3) | 0.57 (#1) | 25.6% (#8) | 1.09 (#1) |
| DEN Defense | 49.2% (#7) | -0.57 (#1) | 50.8% (#26) | 0.32 (#29) | 15.1% (#6) | 0.04 (#10) |

## Blitz & Pressure

| UNIT | BLITZ % | BLITZ EPA | NON-BLITZ EPA | PRESSURE % | PRESSURE EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SF Offense | 23.3% (#30) | 1.54 (#1) | 0.39 (#2) | 29.1% (#2) | 0.22 (#1) |
| DEN Defense | 40.0% (#6) | -0.17 (#11) | -0.08 (#8) | 39.2% (#21) | -0.68 (#5) |

## Pass Depth

| UNIT | SHORT % | SHORT EPA | INTER. % | INTER. EPA | DEEP % | DEEP EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SF Offense | 63.4% (#22) | 0.52 (#1) | 30.5% (#3) | 0.87 (#5) | 6.1% (#28) | 0.87 (#9) |
| DEN Defense | 61.3% (#24) | -0.05 (#15) | 27.4% (#7) | 0.02 (#5) | 11.3% (#15) | -0.12 (#9) |

## Defensive Personnel & Box Count

| UNIT | BASE % | BASE EPA | NICKEL % | NICKEL EPA | LIGHT BOX % | LIGHT BOX EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SF Offense | 42.0% (#7) | 0.37 (#1) | 46.5% (#29) | 0.30 (#1) | 34.4% (#30) | 0.61 (#1) |
| DEN Defense | 30.6% (#17) | 0.09 (#25) | 54.1% (#21) | -0.28 (#2) | 42.3% (#18) | -0.07 (#11) |

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**Kansas City Chiefs @ Las Vegas Raiders: How does the Raiders offense match up with the Chiefs defense?**

- The Raiders have been a pleasant surprise so far this year, and they rank 15th in EPA/play and 24th in EPA/rush. Kirk Cousins is an astounding 6th in EPA/play when pressured so far this season, and we will be monitoring if that can continue. Klint Kubiak has been able to generate explosives off play action and will constantly find a way to get his #1 threat the ball.
- The Chiefs defense is 3rd in EPA/play allowed and 1st in EPA/dropback allowed. They are elite against 11 personnel and are a bit closer to average against heavier looks. Mansoor Delane, Kristian Fulton, and Nohl Williams have produced strong yards allowed per coverage snaps so far this year.
- One matchup to watch here will be the Raiders off play action. The Raiders are 1st in EPA/play off play action, and the Chiefs are 28th in EPA/play in that situation.
- We also want to see what the Chiefs will do when Brock Bowers is in the slot. Bowers may find himself in a positive matchup with L'Jarius Sneed if the Chiefs aren't rotating extra help in that direction. Kansas City does have multiple outside cornerbacks they can feel comfortable with, but Bowers showed the ability to win outside in isolation situations against the Saints.

# LV Offense vs. KC Defense

Week 4 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-3 data · raw EPA • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

## Overall

| UNIT | EPA/PLAY | EPA/DB | EPA/RUSH | SUCCESS RATE | PASS OE | EXPLOSIVE % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| LV Offense | -0.01 (#15) | 0.15 (#11) | -0.20 (#24) | 41.1% (#20) | -1.4% (#21) | 7.2% (#26) |
| KC Defense | -0.18 (#3) | -0.26 (#1) | -0.06 (#20) | 34.7% (#2) | -4.6% (#5) | 7.5% (#8) |

## Personnel Usage

| UNIT | 11P % | 11P EPA | 12P % | 12P EPA | 21P % | 21P EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| LV Offense | 26.7% (#32) | -0.12 (#22) | 29.4% (#10) | 0.25 (#3) | 25.0% (#4) | -0.02 (#8) |
| KC Defense | 56.6% (#19) | -0.27 (#4) | 21.4% (#18) | 0.02 (#17) | 11.6% (#5) | -0.09 (#17) |

## Run & Play Action Identity

| UNIT | ZONE % | ZONE EPA | PA % | PA EPA | UC % | UC EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| LV Offense | 55.4% (#16) | -0.21 (#23) | 28.3% (#13) | 0.51 (#1) | 51.1% (#6) | -0.08 (#25) |
| KC Defense | 53.4% (#21) | -0.25 (#9) | 34.3% (#3) | 0.29 (#28) | 39.3% (#19) | 0.13 (#27) |

## Safety Shell & Middle of Field

| UNIT | 1-HIGH % | 1-HIGH EPA | 2-HIGH % | 2-HIGH EPA | MOF % | MOF EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| LV Offense | 42.4% (#9) | 0.45 (#2) | 57.6% (#24) | -0.08 (#22) | 22.0% (#14) | -0.11 (#28) |
| KC Defense | 30.2% (#22) | -0.46 (#4) | 69.8% (#11) | -0.18 (#3) | 20.4% (#15) | 0.19 (#12) |

## Blitz & Pressure

| UNIT | BLITZ % | BLITZ EPA | NON-BLITZ EPA | PRESSURE % | PRESSURE EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| LV Offense | 26.3% (#23) | 0.04 (#14) | 0.18 (#7) | 38.4% (#15) | 0.02 (#5) |
| KC Defense | 29.2% (#12) | -0.44 (#5) | -0.19 (#5) | 40.6% (#11) | -0.94 (#1) |

## Pass Depth

| UNIT | SHORT % | SHORT EPA | INTER. % | INTER. EPA | DEEP % | DEEP EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| LV Offense | 68.1% (#13) | 0.23 (#3) | 23.1% (#12) | 0.10 (#26) | 8.8% (#22) | 0.57 (#13) |
| KC Defense | 71.0% (#10) | -0.30 (#2) | 15.1% (#31) | 0.56 (#21) | 14.0% (#9) | -0.28 (#5) |

## Defensive Personnel & Box Count

| UNIT | BASE % | BASE EPA | NICKEL % | NICKEL EPA | LIGHT BOX % | LIGHT BOX EPA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| LV Offense | 47.2% (#2) | -0.03 (#17) | 47.8% (#26) | -0.04 (#18) | 35.6% (#29) | -0.07 (#20) |
| KC Defense | 29.5% (#19) | 0.09 (#24) | 57.2% (#17) | -0.24 (#3) | 39.9% (#24) | -0.38 (#3) |

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